

Assignment: Research Paper on Indian Knowledge Systems (IKS)

Submission on 10th September 2026

Course: Indian Knowledge Systems (IKS)

Students are required to prepare an **individual research paper of 5–6 pages** based on **any one topic** from the list given below.

The research paper should demonstrate the student's understanding of the selected aspect of Indian Knowledge Systems and critically examine its **historical foundations, principles, applications, and contemporary relevance**.

Students must support their discussion with **reliable and credible sources**, such as books, research papers, academic journals, government websites, institutional publications, and credible educational resources.

Suggested Topics

1. **Vedic Mathematics: Principles, Origins and Contemporary Applications**
2. **Śulba Sūtras and the Development of Geometry in Ancient India**
3. **Vāstuśāstra as an Indian Architectural and Environmental Knowledge System**
4. **Ancient Indian Metallurgy: Techniques, Innovations and Material Technologies**
5. **Arthaśāstra and Ancient Indian Economic and Administrative Systems**
6. **Nyāya, Law and Governance Systems in Ancient India**
7. **Nāṭyaśāstra: Dance, Theatre, Aesthetics and Knowledge Systems**
8. **Samaveda and the Origins of Indian Classical Music**
9. **Rāga and Tāla: The Knowledge System of Indian Classical Music**
10. **Ayurveda as a Holistic System of Health and Well-being**
11. **Yoga and Prāṇāyāma: Traditional Knowledge and Contemporary Well-being**
12. **Traditional Indian Food Science: Nutrition, Fermentation and Preservation**
13. **Indian Knowledge Systems and Sustainable Living**
14. **Role of Indian Knowledge Systems in Contemporary Education**
15. **Relevance of Indian Knowledge Systems in Modern Society and Nation Building**

Research Paper Structure

1. Title Page

Include:

- Title of the research paper
- Student Name
- Roll Number
- Class/Division
- Course: Indian Knowledge Systems
- Name of Faculty
- Academic Year

2. Abstract

A brief **150–200 word summary** covering the topic, purpose of the research, methodology, major findings and conclusion.

3. Introduction

Introduce the selected IKS topic and provide its historical and conceptual background.

4. Research Objectives

Mention **3–4 clear objectives** of the research.

5. Research Methodology

Explain how the research was conducted. Since this is a **secondary research paper**, students may use:

- Books
- Research papers
- Academic journals
- Government/institutional websites
- Credible educational resources
- Published reports and scholarly databases

6. Main Discussion / Analysis

Discuss the selected topic in detail. Students should include:

- Historical background
- Major principles/concepts
- Development and evolution
- Examples or case studies
- Critical analysis
- Contribution to Indian knowledge traditions

7. Contemporary Relevance

Explain how the selected knowledge system is relevant to **present-day society, education, technology, culture, health, environment, economy or professional practices**, wherever applicable.

8. Findings

Present the major observations and findings emerging from the research.

9. Conclusion

Summarise the key arguments and explain the overall significance of the selected IKS topic.

10. References / Bibliography

List **all sources consulted and cited** in the research paper using a consistent referencing style such as **APA**.

General Guidelines

- **Individual assignment**
- **Length:** 6 pages (*excluding Title Page and References*)
- Use **credible and verifiable sources**.
- Avoid relying solely on blogs, Wikipedia, or AI-generated content.
- Students should **critically analyse** the topic rather than simply describe it.
- Any historical or scientific claim should be supported with an appropriate source.
- Proper **in-text citations and references** are required.
- Plagiarism and direct copying from online sources will not be accepted.
- Students may include relevant **tables, diagrams, photographs, charts or illustrations** where appropriate.
- The assignment should be submitted in **PDF format** unless otherwise instructed by the faculty.